CONNOR MURPHY

(603) 362-2061
cmurphy1140@gmail.com
Vero Beach, FL
linkedin.com/in/cam1140

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Dear Hiring Manager,

This cover letter is my opportunity to represent myself. It's integral that your team is given an authentic understanding of the résumé. I am applying for [ROLE] at [COMPANY]. I have been deliberate about the roles I pursue, looking for useful work with clear responsibility and colleagues I can learn from. Your work on [SPECIFIC PRODUCT OR SERVICE] stood out to me because [ONE CONCRETE CONNECTION TO MY EXPERIENCE OR INTERESTS].

I am a University of New Hampshire computer science graduate. Over two summers at Liberty Mutual, I developed Java components on AWS Lambda, tested data transformations and documented handoffs adopted by the engineering team. That team offered me a full-time TechStart software engineer position.

At Sandridge Golf Club, I'm the first person called when the point-of-sale or booking system goes down. I fix what I can on the spot, hand county IT or the vendor a clear account of the rest, and keep the pro shop, maintenance and the county office working from the same tee sheet.

My projects put that approach into practice. Catch 5 tests whether illegal moves leave the game unchanged. It is a working iPhone app my family plays, not a repository waiting for a user. Tuning the computer opponents taught me to measure a change before trusting a hunch.

My home-automation client separates request success from observed device state. The controller can answer yes while the light stays off, so every command ends as confirmed, unconfirmed, failed or refused, with the evidence attached. I timed the system's slowest turn-on and built the wait around it, so a light still moving is never reported as finished.

Drive Score revisits telematics processing with synthetic trips; scoring and deployment remain in development. It is the internship problem rebuilt on my own: when the broker goes down, trips wait on disk in order, and a trip delivered twice still counts once.

My work in K–8 physical education, restaurants and golf-course operations taught me patience, better questions and the value of keeping things simple. Teaching pickleball to competitive teenagers and younger classes meant learning the game well enough to explain it with the care each group deserved. In a busy restaurant, I learned to slow down, find a steady rhythm, then speed up. Conversations with older golfers taught me to simplify my questions and listen to experience. Together, those lessons taught me that balance comes more easily when I keep things simple and listen to good advice.

Ideas are cheap, and development is fast, so I've learned to be pragmatically slow: quick to build, careful about what deserves building. I use LLMs the way a responsible developer uses Stack Overflow: I review the suggestions, understand the code and test it before using it. I am applying for roles that combine my computer science foundation with the confidence to back myself, and I would be glad to grow with your team.

Thank you for your time reading this. A cover and a summary can introduce the story, but I'd welcome the chance for your team to meet the author. I found pleasure in revisiting and rewriting my

projects, and I feel confident in what I can bring. Any feedback would be generous. I know you're taking a risk on someone early in his career; I'm ready to take that step with you, and I believe we're on the same page.

Eager to hear back,

Connor Murphy